Compare the tooth rows

A zipper clicks together.

Name _____ Date _____

Use the printed counts. The illustrations are not exact data.

1. One sample zipper has 38 elements along a pocket. Another has 46. Put >, <, or = in the circle. Which is the greater count?

38 ○ 46

Show your thinking.

2. A long bag zipper has 72 elements. A short pouch zipper has 27. Put >, <, or = in the circle. Which is the greater count?

72 ○ 27

Show your thinking.

3. A zipper design gives the left tape 54 elements and the right tape 54 elements. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What shared count do the matching rows have?

54 ○ 54

Show your thinking.

Compare the tooth rows

A zipper clicks together.

Name _____ Date _____

Use the printed counts. The illustrations are not exact data.

4. A design note lists 43 zipper elements. What is 43 rounded to the nearest ten?

43 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

5. Another zipper design lists 67 elements. What is 67 rounded to the nearest ten?

67 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

6. A long zipper design lists 95 elements. What is 95 rounded to the nearest ten?

95 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

A moving boundary

Below the slider, two tooth rows stood apart. Above it, they made one joined row. Little wondered what happened inside.

Bump meets pocket

Each zipper element had a bump and a pocket. Left and right elements alternated, nesting across the middle to hold together.

A hidden Y path

Inside the slider, two channels curved around a center wedge and met. Angled walls guided both tooth rows inward.

One after another

The channel lined up left and right elements. Bump met pocket, then the next pair followed. A flexible zipper chain formed behind the slider.

The wedge separates

Moving back sent the joined row toward the center wedge. It guided one side left and the other right, opening the zipper.

Click at the stop

The last elements nested. The slider clicked against the top stop, which kept it from running off the closed row.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

WONDER DAILY

A zipper clicks together.

Give the mechanism your words.

A zipper clicks together. · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose a scene. Look, say an idea, then draw or write.



Where open becomes closed



Bumps fit pockets



A Y inside the slider

Draw the slider's Y-shaped path. Add arrows to show two rows becoming one.

element · slider · channel · interlock · wedge · because · however

At the boundary, … what is separate and what is joined?

The teeth hold because … how do the bumps and pockets fit?

Inside the slider, … what does the Y-shaped channel guide?

Read your words aloud. Did you connect a shape to its job with because, so, or however?